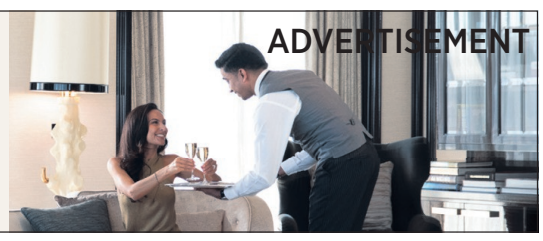
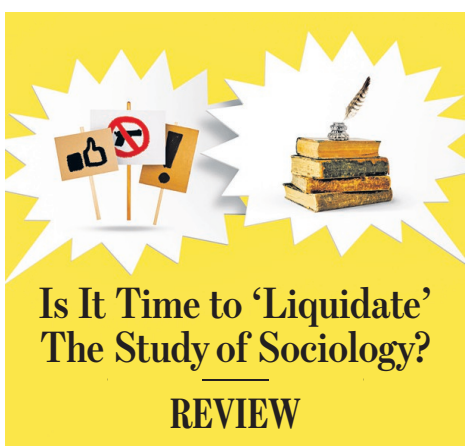
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Is It Time to 'Liquidate' The Study of Sociology?

REVIEW

WSJ
THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Paramount won't move** forward with its merger with Warner Bros. Discovery until legal challenges to the deal are resolved or June 1, 2027, whichever comes first. **B1**

◆ **Verizon beat Wall Street** expectations on a metric that gauges new lucrative customers and said it is pursuing new revenue opportunities, including from the AI infrastructure boom. **B9**

◆ **SpaceX launched** its huge rocket on another test flight Friday, the first since the Elon Musk-led company's history-making IPO. **B9**

◆ **Robinhood is in talks** with digital-currency exchange Crypto.com to expand the brokerage firm's foothold in prediction markets. **B10**

◆ **The Nasdaq fell** 2.1% during the week while the S&P 500 and Dow lost 0.6% and 0.4%, respectively. Brent crude rose 10% for the week. **B10**

◆ **Volkswagen cut its sales** forecasts for the year following a collapse in China's car market and rapid gains by Chinese automakers in its European heartlands. **B9**

◆ **SAP shares climbed** after the business-software group logged strong revenue figures in the second quarter. **B10**

Worldwide

◆ **Bahrain and Kuwait** secretly sent jets to attack sites inside Iran, their first such direct retaliation against Tehran, people familiar with the matter said. **A1, A8**

◆ **The U.S. will consider** applying additional tariffs to goods from the EU in response to fines the bloc has levied against U.S. tech firms. **A2**

◆ **A teenager pleaded** guilty to killing two students and two teachers and injuring nine other people in a 2024 Georgia school shooting. **A3**

◆ **Produce giant** Taylor Farms asked the White House to delay announcing a recall tied to one of the largest foodborne illness outbreaks in U.S. history. **A4**

◆ **Measles cases in the U.S.** during the first seven months of this year have surpassed all of 2025's tally, setting a three-decade high. **A6**

◆ **The ICC ousted** chief prosecutor Karim Khan from office over sexual assault allegations against him. **A7**

◆ **A South Korean** appeals court ordered an AI tech mogul to pay his ex-wife roughly $645 million in the nation's "divorce of the century." **A7**

OPINION
James Taranto: Jim Crow, Title IX and the facts of life. **A11**

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Fires Turn French Beaches to Holiday Hellscape



MAXIMILIEN LAMY/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

HAZY HAZARD: The beach in Lacanau, France, is nearly empty Friday as clouds of smoke from a wildfire can be seen. Tens of thousands of residents and tourists are fleeing as blazes fueled by a summer of heat waves rage in southwestern Europe. **A7**

Inside China's All-Out Campaign To Catch Up With U.S AI Chips

By Josh Chin And Raffaele Huang

Last summer, top Chinese chip developer Huawei Technologies held a closed-door briefing for the country's technology czar to introduce its latest artificial-intelligence chips. The company laid out a plan for rivaling American behemoth Nvidia and said China could become self-sufficient in some critical areas of AI within three years.

It was just what Ding Xuexiang, a confidant of Chinese leader Xi Jinping, wanted to hear. Three years earlier, Washington had squeezed China's access to cutting-edge AI chips and the tools required to manufacture them—a potentially crippling blow to the country's ambitions as a tech power. With Xi's blessing, Vice Premier Ding started a fevered effort to forge domestic alternatives.

Ding dusted off the same all-out approach China had used to produce its first atomic bombs, hydrogen bombs and satellites in the 1960s during a rift with the Soviet Union. He set up a committee that drew from the country's best companies and labs to form specialized teams and directed them

Please turn to page A10

Bahrain, Kuwait Hit Iran In Rare Reprisal

U.S. allies covertly conducted airstrikes earlier this month, a first since war began

By Summer Said And Shelby Holliday

Bahrain and Kuwait secretly sent jets to attack sites inside Iran, their first such direct retaliation against Tehran and an indication of the difficult position Arab states find themselves in as the war grinds on, people familiar with the matter said.

The airstrikes this month targeted drone- and missile-storage depots, among other military sites, some of the people said. The United Arab Emirates—which attacked Iran multiple times early in the war—provided intelligence on targets and defensive air cover for the strikes in a sign of budding Arab cooperation in confronting Iran, those people said.

Iran for weeks has focused its retaliatory strikes on Bahrain and Kuwait, both of which host U.S. military bases. The

Please turn to page A8

◆ U.S. and Iran stuck in a cycle of escalation..... A8

EXCHANGE



IT'S TOKENOMICS
Corporate America has suddenly decided to stop blowing money on AI. **B1**

Priced Out In Florida? This Place Is Booming.

By Arian Campo-Flores

LEHIGH ACRES, Fla.—Desiree and Christian De Leon, Miami natives who spent years renting in South Florida and Orlando, wanted to buy a house somewhere in the state and start building equity. Yet the cost of living kept climbing in each place they went, pushing home prices out of their reach.

Then they discovered Lehigh Acres, a vast exurban community east of Fort Myers where Desiree's parents had moved and where plenty of listings were in their price range. Last year, they bought a newly built three-bedroom house for $328,000, with a monthly mortgage payment almost equal to what they were paying in rent for a one-bedroom apartment in Orlando.

"We were so impressed with what Lehigh has to offer," Desiree, 37 years old, said. "The possibilities were endless."

Lehigh Acres, about 17 miles from Fort Myers, is booming, fueled by arrivals from Miami and elsewhere who are drawn to one of the few remaining affordable areas in the southern part of the state. Florida more broadly is contending with an affordability problem, as soaring home

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Trump Trade Map Gets New Route

By Greg Ip

ANALYSIS

The House of Representatives' trade oversight committee maintains a compilation of all U.S. trade statutes. More than 1,400 pages, it is an authoritative reference among trade experts and attorneys.

A decade ago, veteran trade lawyer John Veroneau noticed it didn't include Section 338 of the infamous Smoot-Hawley tariff law of 1930, which authorizes tariffs against countries that discriminate against the U.S. When he pointed this out, he recalled, a committee staffer said, surely this has been repealed?

It wasn't, and this past week President Trump said he would use it for the first time

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◆ President threatens new tariffs on EU..... A2
◆ U.S. to resume cattle imports from Mexico..... A3

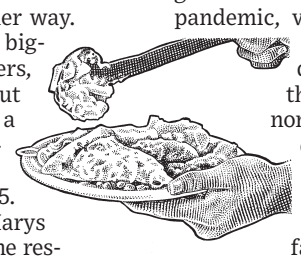
The Lonely Fight to Keep The Cheap Las Vegas Buffet Alive

* * *

A few old-school hotels are dead set on keeping the all-you-can-eat circus going

By Rachel Louise Ensign

LAS VEGAS—The 11 restaurants at the South Point hotel and casino here lose between $1.5 million and $2 million a month. The owner wouldn't have it any other way.



All in

One of the biggest money losers, serving about 3,000 people a day, is the buffet. Breakfast starts at $16.95. Two Bloody Marys are included. The restaurant used to offer unlimited drinks, but stopped after a customer fell over drunk.

"You can come to Vegas and do whatever you want," said general manager Ryan Growney, wearing a black cowboy hat. "In the buffet, you can eat whatever you can imagine."

This city used to have lots of cheap, all-you-can eat venues like the South Point's, money-losing restaurants that brought people in the door to gamble. Many closed after the pandemic, victims of social-distancing requirements and the changing economics of a city now dominated by affluent travelers eager to splurge on fancy meals.

In March 2020, professors writing an academic paper on customer satisfaction evaluated more than a dozen buffets on the Strip. Only four of those remain.

The buffet at the South Point keeps getting busier.

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